Incident Report: Repeated Failed Logons on Windows-Employee

Nov 8, 2026 · Khayal

Wazuh detected six failed logons for the local account Employye on the Windows-Employee lab machine within about one minute. The source was the machine itself (127.0.0.1, logon type 2), so this was a controlled simulation in my own lab, not an external attack.

Environment

The test ran in my own VirtualBox lab. Traffic between the two machines uses a host-only network (192.168.56.0/24). Each VM also has a NAT adapter for internet access, used only to download software.

Component	Details
SIEM	Wazuh 4.14.9 (all-in-one), Ubuntu Server 24.04, 192.168.56.10
Monitored endpoint	Windows 11 Home VM, Wazuh agent name Windows-Employee (ID 001), 192.168.56.20
Windows computer name	KHAYAL
Log source	Windows Security event log, collected by the Wazuh agent
Activity performed	Wrong passwords entered at the Windows sign-in screen (Wazuh recorded 6 failures), then a correct sign-in

Detection and timeline

Wazuh rule 60122, “Logon Failure - Unknown user or bad password” (level 5, groups: windows, windows_security, authentication_failed), fired 6 times on Windows event ID 4625. Searching `rule.groups: authentication_failed` in Threat Hunting returned exactly these six alerts.

#	Time (Oct 31, 2026, Asia/Riyadh UTC+3)	Rule	Level
1	00:24:01	60122	5
2	00:24:46	60122	5
3	00:24:50	60122	5
4	00:24:55	60122	5
5	00:24:58	60122	5
6	00:25:05	60122	5

Investigation

I opened the first alert (00:25:05) and read the fields that answer three questions: who was targeted, where the attempt came from, and what happened.

Question	Field	Value	Reading
What happened?	data.win.system.eventID	4625	Windows logged a failed logon
What happened?	data.win.eventdata.status	0xC000006D	Logon failure
What happened?	data.win.eventdata.subStatus	0xC000006A	Wrong password for an existing account
Who was targeted?	data.win.eventdata.targetUserName	Employye	An existing local account
Where from?	data.win.eventdata.ipAddress	127.0.0.1	The machine itself, not the network
How?	data.win.eventdata.logonType	2	Interactive logon at the sign-in screen
How?	data.win.eventdata.logonProcessName	User32	Standard Windows sign-in process

Question	Field	Value	Reading
How many?	rule.firedtimes	6	Rule fired six times

A remote brute-force attempt would normally show logon type 3 and an external source IP. Here both point to local, interactive activity.

Indicators of compromise

In this lab case the indicators describe my own simulation. In a real incident the source IP would be the most useful one.

Type	Value
Targeted account	Employye
Host	KHAYAL (Wazuh agent Windows-Employee, ID 001, 192.168.56.20)
Source address	127.0.0.1 (local)
Windows event	4625, logon type 2
Wazuh rule	60122, level 5
Activity window	6 failures in about one minute, 00:24:01 to 00:25:05

MITRE ATT&CK mapping

Wazuh tags rule 60122 as T1531 Account Access Removal (tactic: Impact). That is the rule's own label. The behavior I simulated, repeated wrong passwords against one account, is closer to T1110 Brute Force (Credential Access). Six attempts by one person do not make a real brute-force campaign, so I record both and treat T1110 as a description of the pattern, not a confirmed technique.

Source	Technique	Tactic
Tagged by Wazuh (rule 60122)	T1531 Account Access Removal	Impact
Closest to the simulated pattern (my assessment)	T1110 Brute Force	Credential Access

Conclusion and recommendations

This was a simulated activity in a controlled lab: local, interactive, and low severity (level 5). Wazuh detected every attempt, which confirms the Windows Security log is reaching the SIEM and the authentication rules work.

In a real environment I would:

- Set an account lockout threshold, so repeated failures lock the account temporarily.
- Alert when failures repeat in a short window for one account or one source IP.
- Prioritise failures with logon type 3 (network) or an external source IP over local logon type 2.
- Require MFA for any remote access to the account.